r/realtors · 2mo ago
Cleverfield113

Seasoned agents: how do you handle the slow periods?

Discussion

I've been an agent for about 8 years (full time for 5). I've been fairly successful, bringing home about $200k per year since I went full time. I know that there are always ups and downs, but I still find myself getting really down on myself and questioning whether I'm good at my job during the slow times. How have you learned how to deal with it?

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AutoModerator MOD · 2mo ago

gooddaytoreddit · 2mo ago

I buy a rental property a year. This serves a few purposes in that you get a little steady monthly income each month but also lead me to a lot of realtor business working with other investors.

10 Reply Award Share

Cleverfield113 OP · 2mo ago · Edited 2mo ago

I actually do own several rental properties, which helps me financially, but it doesn't stop me from getting down on myself.

7 Reply Award Share

TigerEmmaLily · 2mo ago

Sell one ☝️ lol 😂

0 Reply Award Share

Acceptable_String_52 · 2mo ago

You buy a rental property a year in this economy? Damn you are rich

7 Reply Award Share

whatfingwhat · 2mo ago

I up my drinking

85 Reply Award Share

PeteDub · 2mo ago

Ha! The salesperson's way

9 Reply Award Share

polishrocket · 2mo ago

True real estate agent right here!

15 Reply Award Share

TigerEmmaLily · 2mo ago

I go to AA

2 Reply Award Share

Squidbilly37 · 2mo ago
Realtor

Since I got sober, my production has gone up year after year

5 Reply Award Share

TigerEmmaLily · 2mo ago

Amazing and SAME!

3 Reply Award Share

Wonderful-Field7278 · 2mo ago

😂

1 Reply Award Share

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sneaking-suspicion · 2mo ago
Realtor

Double down on prospecting when your schedule is slow. Call (don't text or email) every lead that's called you in the past 6 months and see if they may be ready to act, then check in with all of your past clients! Prospect, prospect, prospect! Your schedule and your bank account will fill up quickly.

34 Reply Award Share

Dear_Choice_6131 · 2mo ago

That's solid advice. The only gap is that manual prospecting depends entirely on your energy and time, which is why results fluctuate. A lot of agents now automate the first layer of follow-ups and reactivation so calls happen only after leads are warmed up instead of chasing cold lists.

Are you doing all follow-ups manually right now or using any automation?

5 Reply Award Share

sneaking-suspicion · 2mo ago
Realtor

IMHO, these are warm leads not cold. While they may be a little stale, they inquired about real estate recently. Hopefully when they did you had a conversation with them to determine they weren't really ready or if you didn't have a conversation with them, at least you've left several messages, sent texts, put them on an email drip and maybe even sent them a few pieces of mail. This means they've heard your name and know what you do when you do finally reach them. It's amazing, I can look in my notes to see I've done all the above for several months with no response, then when I do get them on the phone they apologize for not yet returning my call then open up to a great real estate conversation.

We have tried 2 voice AI agents and 1 texting AI agent and I just didn't get as good of responses as when I sit down and hammer the calls out. Actually, I call and if they don't answer, I leave a message, then send a text.

Energy and time... OP was looking for advice during slow times. Sounds like OP has the time. In today's market, you can't sit around and wait for the phone to ring, go get that business! Make the calls, you will get a lot of rejection and no answers, but you will also get some people ready or about ready to go! I like this analogy... If you were a caveman sitting in your cave and the family was hungry, would you sit there and hope a rabbit happened to hop in so you could eat, or would you go out and hunt for and get that wholly mammoth! Make the calls, hunt for your next deal!

My coach asks, "are you prospecting like you life depends on it?"

9 Reply Award Share

LordLandLordy · 2mo ago

I was going to write exactly this. :)

5 Reply Award Share

[deleted] · 2mo ago

Dear_Choice_6131 · 2mo ago

Fair take. Sounds like execution matters more than tools.

When you tried AI agents was the problem quality of convo or timing/follow-up flow? I'm studying how agents actually use AI alongside real calling.

Mind if I DM you to ask a couple quick things?

1 Reply Award Share

sneaking-suspicion · 2mo ago
Realtor

Sure DM me.

AI agents. The first company we worked with, the AI was asking dumb questions. Asking buyers leads what they thought their home was worth when we hadn't established they were a homeowner for example. There were multiple instances that showed us the company we were working with had no idea how real estate worked or how to talk to our customers.

On the 2nd and 3rd, Sometimes they made the connections, sometimes they didn't. Out of 100 leads coming in, they made the call or text about 30% of the time and would engage someone in a conversation about 3% of the time. 3 connections out of 100 is not worth the $$'s spent. Maybe if it was actually attempting to connect with all 100 leads and got 10% conversations started, it might be worth it.

For the time being I think my team has decided the personal touch is going to be our value. Actually having a live agent on the phone that can actually have a great live conversation and answer questions..... until AI gets a little smarter. We will save the AI for copywriting and spreadsheet coding and evaluating data.

2 Reply Award Share

AutoModerator MOD · 2mo ago

Please note that it is not permitted to solicit business to our members, even in PM. That is against our spam rules- This behavior can result in a permanent ban. Ignore this message if incorrect.

If this person is soliciting please report it to the moderators to ban them from commenting in the subreddit.

I am a bot, and this action was performed automatically. Please contact the moderators of this subreddit if you have any questions or concerns.

1 Reply Award Share

vialine · 2mo ago

Thank you for a detailed insights, What is your take on utilizing social media for your listing?

1 Reply Award Share

sneaking-suspicion · 2mo ago
Realtor

We do a paid Facebook ad for each listing, just 4 photos and a link to our website for more details. Same for open houses and if we have a price adjustment. We also post on Marketplace and share to local "for sale or for rent" pages. That's about it.

1 Reply Award Share

Lazy-Conversation-48 · 2mo ago

Yup - I start brainstorming or networking with lenders, etc.

1 Reply Award Share

PizbuffRakiThenNerf · 2mo ago
Top 1% Commenter

Live within my means all year, go on vacation, wait until March.

15 Reply Award Share

ihatepostingonblogs · 2mo ago

Remember it's temporary, try and have some fun during the downtime and always use the time to be planning ahead. What we do today is actually for 3 months from now.

9 Reply Award Share

Dear_Choice_6131 · 2mo ago

Slow periods usually come from earlier pipeline gaps. Use the time to build systems that generate inbound consistently so future months aren't reactive.

How much of your lead flow is automated right now?

4 Reply Award Share

u/base44_app · Promoted

Your idea. Your app. Type it out and see it working in minutes with Base44. Start building today.

Sign Up base44.com

From prompt to product

Sea_moore · 2mo ago

Go on vacation. You know how it is. Everyone and their mom will hit you up for stuff.

Works every time

9 Reply Award Share

BigExplanationmay6 · 2mo ago

Book a vacation with a nonrefundable deposit. That and take all your CE classes, then do the stuff at home that you put off 'cause you didn't have enough hours in the same day, the rest of the year. I pack a lot into the downtime season...

8 Reply Award Share

jjt838 · 2mo ago

This business is mentally taxing for so many reasons. The slow months can be especially hard to push through. You start to feel like the phone is never going to ring and the thoughts creep in about whether you are going to earn enough this year. I feel it right now, and I am a seasoned and successful agent. Eventually the phone does start ringing. The deals come together. If you are fortunate, by June or July it can almost feel like too much at once. That is the cycle. There is nothing easy or fun about having a job without a salary or guaranteed paycheck. Some days I truly hate that part of it. But this is my career, and after 15 years I'm not changing it now. The upsides to this business are obvious. But with every upside comes a downside, and learning to manage both is part of the gig.

7 Reply Award Share

Dear_Choice_6131 · 2mo ago

That honesty is real. Cycles don't disappear even after years, but what usually helps is reducing uncertainty where you can control it. The more predictable your inbound systems and follow-ups are, the less emotional weight slow periods carry because you know activity is still happening underneath.

Are most of your leads coming reactively or do you have structured inbound running consistently?

2 Reply Award Share

jjt838 · 2mo ago

I have a really specialized business where I primarily focus on one neighborhood and at the moment I'm the go to person for the most part down there. So buyers find me via website and past sales and sellers know me. However that all sounds great but it never gives me comfort. I still go through the fear of having an off year every year around this time. With that said I don't sit around waiting for the phone to ring. I'm sending mailers (which I do constantly) I'm getting my website updated I'm talking with other agents about their buyers wants for the upcoming Season. But the fear is real but then again so are the Wednesday lunches with friends. So you take the good with the bad.

1 Reply Award Share

gptbuilder_marc · 2mo ago

Five years at around 200k a year isn't someone bad at what they do.

When it slows down, does it usually trace back to a dry patch 60–90 days earlier, or does it feel like the market just flipped on you?

That answer changes whether this is personal or just pipeline math.

6 Reply Award Share

WWMannySantosDo · 2mo ago

Make more connections and find a way to feel purposeful even when you aren't closing deals. Get yourself out in your community, volunteer, reach out to clients to check in more. Take classes and expand your knowledge. Also spend more time refining your business value positions and systems so when things pick back up again, you're more prepared than ever before.

5 Reply Award Share

Dear_Choice_6131 · 2mo ago

Slow periods are usually a systems gap, not a talent issue. Tighten follow-ups, automate lead tracking, and keep prospecting consistent so pipeline doesn't dry up. Many agents lose momentum because everything is manual.

Have you looked into automating parts of your lead handling or follow-ups yet?

-1 Reply Award Share

Pitiful-Place3684 · 2mo ago
Top 1% Commenter

What do you mean by "handle"? Emotional resilience...?

4 Reply Award Share

Warm_Scheme2146 · 2mo ago

First off, bringing in $200k consistently is no small thing. Slow periods don't erase that.

I think even seasoned agents underestimate how psychological this business is. When deals are flowing, confidence is high. When it's quiet, it's easy to start questioning your ability instead of recognizing it as a cycle.

What's helped me (and others I've talked to) is focusing on controllables during slow seasons — prospecting consistency, follow-ups, skill sharpening, reconnecting with past clients. Treat it like a planting season instead of a harvesting one.

Also, eight years in proves you're not "bad at your job." Markets shift. Cycles happen. The agents who last are the ones who ride them without letting the slow months define them.

You're probably more stable than you feel right now.

3 Reply Award Share

Dear_Choice_6131 · 2mo ago

Slow periods hit even strong producers, usually because lead flow isn't consistent rather than skill suddenly dropping. Most agents fix this by systemizing pipeline generation so leads keep coming even when they're busy closing.

A lot of teams now automate follow-ups, nurture sequences, and inbound qualification using AI so pipeline doesn't stall during slower cycles and mental pressure drops because activity stays consistent.

Are your slow periods mostly from fewer inbound leads or deals falling off late in the pipeline?

2 Reply Award Share

[deleted] · 2mo ago

finalcutfx · 2mo ago · Edited 2mo ago
Broker

At the moment? I'm on a cruise in the Bahamas.

2 Reply Award Share

Flaky-Statement-2410 · 2mo ago

By learning to appreciate the slow period and not stressing. BEcause some how at the end of every year, one way or another you ended up making the same range.

2 Reply Award Share

Reddittooh · 2mo ago

I remind myself that this is seasonally slow. A few months from now I will wish for down time... now I have downtime.

2 Reply Award Share

mellylovesdundun · 2mo ago

I'm in the same boat. A lot of agents are slow right now. Even the successful ones. Try to hang in there

2 Reply Award Share

kloakndaggers · 2mo ago

rentals is always the answer. I sit on my ass and watch my kids and do hobbies. being a realtor is the side gig

3 Reply Award Share

Positive-Fox3161 · 2mo ago

Where are you buying rentals?

2 Reply Award Share

kloakndaggers · 2mo ago

in my home state of Illinois. in b to a areas. high risk high reward cash only.

0 Reply Award Share

Positive-Fox3161 · 2mo ago

Just curious, average cost per rental? In FL in mcol/hcol seems very hard to cash flow

2 Reply Award Share

kloakndaggers · 2mo ago

usually 200 to 350. it's probably not the best investment but I'm usually able to pick them up pretty consistently due to cash flow from other rentals. I prefer tangible assets at this point. Illinois is still appreciating so it's a bit difficult to buy retail so I need to go off market

0 Reply Award Share

Positive-Fox3161 · 2mo ago

Next question lol. How are you finding off market and how deep of a discount are you buying?

1 Reply Award Share

kloakndaggers · 2mo ago

auctions, wholesalers.

1 Reply Award Share

PeteDub · 2mo ago

Well, have faith in yourself and God. You've gone through it before, and you will again.

If you're slow you should be prospecting for leads most of the day. And work "on" your business. Improve your self and your materials.

If you're anxious, it's best to pray and practice gratitude. And keep yourself busy with something that will improve your situation.

4 Reply Award Share

[deleted] · 2mo ago

ams292 · 2mo ago

I do laundry

1 Reply Award Share

Few_Divide_4424 · 2mo ago

Really feeling like this right now. I made a post about it an about a week ago. Been in for 5 really full in for last 3 and had my best year last year but really feeling down right now. I think we're just in a slow down market. I've had a couple lead gen's dry up and really just been spending the last few days hitting up old clients checking in and trying to find a few more lead gen's. Trying to build my own site/leads too to get away from the all. But the struggle is real right now for most I think

1 Reply Award Share

ScramDiggyBooBoo · 2mo ago

I usually take those times to work on processes or to do some business housekeeping, research new lead generation methods, etc. You don't always have to be productive and if you sit back for a day and take some time for yourself, the world's not going to fall apart. It's actually good for you to take your own mental health day and just step back and relax and enjoy yourself from time to time. Don't live to work, work to live.

1 Reply Award Share

RegieRealtor49 · 2mo ago

We save $ all year to cover the slow times

1 Reply Award Share

jennparsonsrealtor · 2mo ago

I get into the same mental rut, but this year I'm using my "down time" to

1. Nail down a CRM my brain will use consistently
2. Produce valuations for all of my previous Buyer clients
3. Creating a repository of content for my website blog and social media so when it gets busy, my SEO isn't lacking
4. Trying to learn a new skill (in this case, diving into all of the AI applications and how they work, and how they can help me make better online marketing choices).

When producing agents get busy, we get very busy. Sometimes we don't realize how quickly tech evolves while we're swamped with our day to day. Right now is the best time to dive into something you've been wanting to learn, or catch up on.

Lastly, it's a good opportunity to do pop-bys to previous clients. Knock on their door with something small, have a face to face conversation with someone even if it's not about real estate. You'll feel loads better afterwards. Were used to always being "on" with people. When it's slow, we lose that human connection, so go look for it!

1 Reply Award Share

Cbgb712 · 2mo ago

I clean up my pipeline & CRM, catch up on CE, update my marketing for relevance, and get back out to talk to people.

1 Reply Award Share

RealRealEstateAgent0 · 2mo ago

You need to focus on your farm. Everything else in real estate is a treadmill. Zillow, buyer leads, chasing expireds - all treadmill acts. A farm is consistent, it compounds, and it works!

1 Reply Award Share

SheKaep · 2mo ago

How are you defining 'slow period'?

1 Reply Award Share

stokerspoker · 2mo ago

Private money lenders and investors keep me busy every winter. Then I get their retail ready flips in summer.

1 Reply Award Share

Own-Mix4485 · 2mo ago

Listen to bad bunny

1 Reply Award Share

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